ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET A

Political Science Chapter 1: **Power-sharing** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** 59 per cent	40% French, 1% German
2	**(c)** Sinhala	Majoritarian measure
3	**(c)** majoritarianism	Disregards minorities
4	**(c)** four times	Belgian model
5	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A	Accommodation
6	**(b)** people belonging to one language community, no matter where they live	Cultural, educational, language issues
7	**(a)** horizontal distribution of power	Checks and balances
8	**(d)** 2009	Tamil Eelam conflict
9	**(c)** It reduces the possibility of conflict between social groups	Better outcomes
10	**(a)** European Union	European Parliament

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	A social division based on shared culture; people of the same ethnic group believe in their common descent because of similarities of physical type or culture or both.	2
12	A violent conflict between opposing groups within a country that becomes so intense that it appears like a war.	2
13	A system in which each organ of government checks the others, so that none of them can exercise unlimited power and there is a balance of power.	2
14	A government formed when two or more political parties come together and share power after elections.	2

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	1956 Act made Sinhala the only official language, disregarding Tamil; preferential policies favoured Sinhala applicants for university positions and government jobs; new constitution stipulated that the state shall protect and foster Buddhism.	1+1+1
16	Prudential: reduces possibility of conflict between social groups and ensures political stability — e.g. reservation of seats for SCs/STs avoids alienation; Moral: power sharing is the very spirit of democracy — people have a right to be consulted — e.g. Panchayati Raj gives power to local people.	1½+1½
17	Equal number of Dutch and French-speaking ministers in the central government; special laws need support of majority of each linguistic group; many powers given to state governments of the two regions — not subordinate to the centre; Brussels has a separate government with equal representation; community government for cultural, educational and language issues.	3
	OR: Recognition of Tamil as an official language, regional autonomy, equality of opportunity in education and jobs; demand for more autonomy repeatedly denied; by the 1980s organisations demanded an independent Tamil Eelam in the north and east; distrust turned into widespread conflict and civil war.	1½+1½
18	(i) Among organs of government — horizontal distribution (legislature, executive, judiciary) (ii) Among governments at different levels — vertical/federal division (union, state, local) (iii) Among social groups — community government, reserved constituencies (iv) Among political parties, pressure groups and movements — coalition governments, interest groups.	3
	OR: Both are democracies but dealt differently with power sharing; Belgium realised that unity is possible only by respecting the feelings and interests of different communities and regions — mutually acceptable arrangements; Sri Lanka shows that if a majority community forces its dominance and refuses to share power, it can undermine the unity of the country.	3

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers

2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Prudential — reduces conflict between social groups; social conflict leads to violence and political instability; power sharing ensures stability of political order; tyranny of majority oppresses the minority and also affects the majority adversely; imposing majority will undermines unity in the long run. Moral — democratic rule involves sharing power with those affected by its exercise; people have a right to be consulted on how they are governed; a legitimate government is one where citizens, through participation, acquire a stake in the system; prudential stresses better outcomes, moral emphasises the act of power sharing as valuable.	2½+2½
	OR: Belgium — 59% Dutch (Flemish), 40% French (Wallonia), 1% German; Brussels 80% French, 20% Dutch; tensions in 1950s–60s; accommodation through four constitutional amendments — equal ministers, state governments, Brussels government, community government. Sri Lanka — 74% Sinhala, 18% Tamil (13% Sri Lankan Tamils, rest Indian Tamils), 7% Christians; majoritarianism after 1948 — Sinhala only (1956), preferences, Buddhism; alienation, Tamil Eelam demand, civil war till 2009.	5
20	Horizontal — organs of government; ministers responsible to legislature; judges check executive and laws — checks and balances. Vertical — federal government (Union) and state governments; further to municipalities and panchayats. Social groups — Belgium's community government; reserved constituencies for weaker sections and women. Political parties and pressure groups — competition, alliances, coalition governments; interest groups of traders, farmers, workers influence decision-making.	5
	OR: Recognised regional differences and cultural diversities; amended constitution four times (1970–1993); equal Dutch and French ministers; laws needing majority of each group; state governments not subordinate; equal representation in Brussels government; community government; arrangement unique in the world; avoided civic strife and a possible division on linguistic lines; Brussels became EU headquarters.	5

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET B

Political Science Chapter 1: **Power-sharing** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** Luxembourg	Small European country
2	**(d)** 80 per cent	Dutch minority there
3	**(c)** 74 per cent	Major group
4	**(c)** Sri Lankan Tamils	13 per cent
5	**(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A	Discrimination
6	**(b)** Union and State governments	Different levels
7	**(b)** undivided political power	Power in one person/place
8	**(b)** 1948	Independence
9	**(d)** the Dutch-speaking community accepted equal representation in the central government	Mutual accommodation
10	**(c)** People have a right to be consulted on how they are to be governed	Spirit of democracy

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Based on prudence, or careful calculation of gains and losses; prudential decisions are usually contrasted with decisions based purely on moral considerations.	2
12	Power shared among different organs of government — legislature, executive and judiciary — placed at the same level, each exercising different powers.	2
13	Tamils whose forefathers came from India as plantation workers during the colonial period.	2
14	The minority French-speaking community was relatively rich and powerful; the Dutch got the benefit of economic development and education much later.	2

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Reduces possibility of conflict between social groups; ensures stability of political order; prevents tyranny of the majority which harms minority and majority; it is the spirit of democracy — people have a right to be consulted; gives citizens a stake in the system.	3
16	A third kind of government apart from central and state governments, elected by people belonging to one language community — Dutch, French and German-speaking — no matter where they live; it has power regarding cultural, educational and language-related issues.	1+2
17	Belgium's community government; constitutional and legal arrangements for representation of socially weaker sections and women in legislatures and administration; reserved constituencies in India give space to diverse social groups who might otherwise feel alienated; minority communities get a fair share in power.	3
	OR: Competition among parties ensures power does not remain in one hand; in the long run power is shared among parties with different ideologies; alliances and coalition governments share power directly; interest groups of traders, businessmen, farmers, workers participate in government committees or influence decisions.	3
18	French-speaking minority was rich and powerful; Dutch-speaking majority got development and education later; tension in the 1950s and 1960s; more acute in Brussels where Dutch speakers were a minority though a majority in the country.	3
	OR: No; power sharing strengthens unity by accommodating diversity; Belgium avoided division through sharing; Sri Lanka's refusal led to civil war; sharing gives legitimacy and stability.	3

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks

19	People are the source of all political power; self-government institutions; respect for diverse groups; four forms — organs, levels, social groups, parties and pressure groups — with examples; checks and balances; federalism; reservations; coalitions.	5
	OR: Sinhala-only Act 1956; preferential university and job policies; constitution to protect Buddhism; Tamils felt denied equal political rights and discriminated; relations strained; Tamil parties and struggles for language, autonomy, equality; demands denied; Tamil Eelam demand by 1980s; civil war — thousands killed, refugees, lost livelihoods; terrible setback to social, cultural, economic life; ended in 2009.	5
20	Belgium — equal ministers of language groups, state governments, Brussels government, community government; India — horizontal division with checks and balances; federal division with Union, State and local governments; reserved constituencies for SC/ST/women; coalition governments; both accommodate diversity, Belgium through community-based arrangements, India through federal structure and reservations.	5
	OR: Lebanon's civil war; after it, leaders agreed to power sharing — President a Maronite Catholic Christian, PM a Sunni Muslim, Deputy PM an Orthodox Christian, Speaker a Shi'a Muslim; Christians agreed not to seek French protection and Muslims not to seek unification with Syria; Khalil wants regular open elections; elders see the system as a guarantee of peace; teaches that power sharing may need special arrangements for peace, but may conflict with individual opportunity.	5

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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